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NHSRP National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform

BULLETIN

31 December 2024

NDRRMA bids farewell to the Chief Executive, Mr. Anil Pokhrel and Under Secretary Mr. Sundar Sharma.

Photo source: NHSRP

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

I. Government of Nepal approves Disaster-Sensitive Social Security and Relief Distribution Procedure, 2081

II. Earthquake safety day: nationwide efforts for strong structures and robust preparedness

III. Fairwell to First Chief Executive of NDRRMA.

IV. Third national conference on disaster risk reduction (NCDRR).

V. Findings from western Nepal's EP&R assessment

VI. Localizing GEDSI strategic action plan in disaster risk reduction and management

KEY GOVERNMENTAL UPDATES

Government of Nepal approves Disaster-Sensitive Social Security and Relief Distribution Procedure, 2081

On December 31, 2024 (16 Paush, 2081), the Government of Nepal approved the **Disaster-Sensitive Social Security and Relief Distribution Procedure, 2081** through a Cabinet decision. This procedure has been formulated in accordance with **Sub-section (1) of Section 39 of the Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Act, 2074** to enhance disaster response, relief distribution, and recovery efforts. The primary objective of this procedure is to ensure financial accessibility for **economically disadvantaged and vulnerable individuals and families** to all forms of relief and assistance related to disaster response, immediate relief distribution, early recovery, and long-term rehabilitation. By integrating **social security programs and systems**, the government aims to provide **swift, efficient, organized, and effective relief** to disaster-affected populations.

The procedure includes grant provisions for **Emergency Relief Operation and Management, Early Recovery and Relief Operation, Private Housing Retrofitting, Reconstruction, and Rehabilitation, and Livelihood Recovery Assistance Operation.** This initiative is expected to strengthen disaster response mechanisms and enhance resilience among affected communities across Nepal.

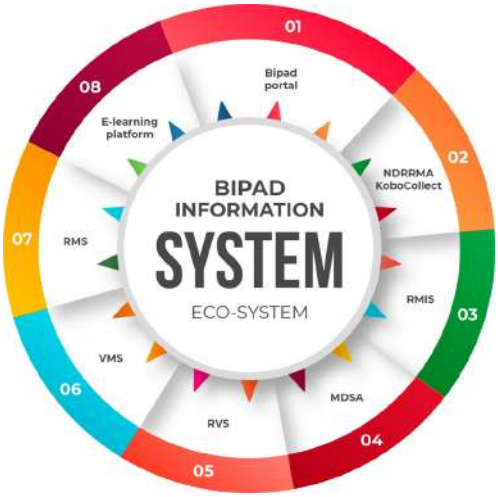
Bidding farewell to NDRRMA's first Chief Executive Mr. Anil Pokhrel

On 16 December 2024, Mr. Anil Pokhrel, National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority's first Chief Executive, concluded his five-year term. NDRRMA family bid farewell to honor his leadership and unwavering dedication.

During his five year term, Mr. Pokhrel played a pivotal role in establishing NDRRMA as Nepal's apex institution for disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM). Under his leadership, the NDRRMA was able to promulgate nearly two dozen legal framework, guideline, standard, policy, strategy, and operational plans for all the four priority areas of the national strategic action plan for DRRM. Some key highlights include the Operational Guidelines for Disaster Management Fund, 2079 BS; National Strategy for Financial Management of Disaster Risk, 2078 BS; Strategic Action Plan for Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion in Disaster Risk Reduction and Management, 2081 BS; Community Resilience and Recovery Integration Guidance in Local Planning, 2081 BS; Procedures for Multi-hazard Temporary Housing Construction Grants for Disaster-Affected Households, 2081 BS; Guidelines for Formation and Mobilization of Disaster Management Volunteer Bureau, 2078 BS; Guidelines for Post-Disaster Dead Body Management, 2068 BS (First Amendment 2076 BS); and Operational Guidelines for Mobilizing Partner Organizations for Disaster Management, 2081 BS; Emergency Command Centre, 2023; annual Monsoon Preparedness and Response National Action Plan, for the years 2020 – 2024 BS, Guidelines for Strengthening, Reconstruction, and Restoration of Disaster-Affected Private Housing Grants, 2081 BS

(Final Draft); Risk Communication Strategy and the national standard for Shock Responsive Social Protection and relief

In addition to policy formulation, NDRRMA made significant strides in advancing the disaster Information management systems. The development and localization of the Bipad Portal, a national integrated disaster information management system, as well as several other platforms such as **RVS**: Rapid Visual Screening; **VMS**: Volunteer Management System; : Resource Mapping System **(GODAM)**, and **e-Learning** Platform **RMIS**: Reconstruction Management Information System, **MDSA**: Monitoring Disaster Strategic Action Plan. In addition to establishing the foundation through the endorsement of the guidelines and framework, NDRRMA focused on localizing them at the provincial, district and local levels. With support from all three tiers of government and development partners, the authority advanced the country's early warning systems, anticipatory action, emergency response, and recovery and reconstruction efforts for communities at risk.



Under Mr. Pokhrel's leadership, NDRRMA successfully led recovery and reconstruction efforts for monsoon and fire-affected households since 2077 BS, building on the lessons learned from the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA). Notably, it laid the foundation for multi-hazard recovery processes, advocating for comprehensive guidelines to address disasters like the Western Nepal earthquake.

In his closing remarks, Mr. Pokhrel emphasized that strengthening communities for disaster risk reduction and management is an ongoing process that requires sustained effort. He highlighted existing gaps in resources, such as financial, human, and operational capacities, and called for continued collaboration among all stakeholders, including federal, provincial, and local governments, development partners, INGOs, NGOs, academic institutions, the private sector, and civil society.

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As a token of appreciation for his remarkable contributions, NHSRP presented Mr. Pokhrel with a special recognition, acknowledging his leadership and collaboration in disaster recovery and risk reduction initiatives. Mr. Anil Pokhrel also commended NHSRP's continuous support to the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) during the Gorkha earthquake recovery process and its ongoing assistance to NDRRMA for multi-hazard reconstruction and recovery efforts. The farewell program marked the end of an era of transformative leadership at

NDRRMA, leaving behind a strong foundation for continued progress in disaster risk reduction and management in Nepal.

The NDRRMA and NHSRP Family bids farewell for Mr. Anil Pokhrel's contribution to DRRM in Nepal!

Third national conference on disaster risk reduction (NCDRR) organized e on December 26-27

The Third National Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction (NCDRR) took place on December 26-27 at The Everest Hotel in Kathmandu. Coordinated by DPNet Nepal and organized by the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA), the conference focused on synthesizing lessons learned and strengthening the nation's resilience against future disasters. The conference was graced by the Home Minister as the chief guest, chaired by Dr. Raju Thapa, the Chairperson of DPNet, and emceed by Suraj Gautam, the General Secretary of DPNet. The conference attended over 300 participants, including key governmental officials, representatives from various development partners, NGOs, academia, and the media. It showcased a concerted effort to encompass all societal segments, especially prioritizing inclusivity for women, people with disabilities, and other vulnerable communities, with amenities such as sign language interpretation and close captioning service available.

Focused on deriving actionable insights from the devastation created by the recent monsoon, the conference's agenda was robust, addressing multiple facets of disaster risk through a series of technical sessions and panel discussions, the agenda and overall session were designed as per the guidance of Joint Secretary of NDRRMA Dr. Bhisma Bhusal. One of the key objectives was to share current research and best practices related to risk management in the rapidly changing climate scenario, enhancing future DRR strategies. Technical sessions delved into understanding various risks, including hydro-meteorological disasters and geological hazards, with a significant emphasis on risk mapping. Another session highlighted the management of risks within the evolving climate dynamics, specifically discussing the impacts on agriculture and the integration of climate change measures into broader DRR strategies. The need for accelerating actions towards sustainable futures was also a focal point, with discussions around sustainable housing solutions, recovery systems, and the potential of innovative technologies such as blockchain for activating early response mechanisms.

Panel discussions provided a platform for diverse stakeholders to share firsthand experiences and lessons learned from the monsoon responses. These discussions spanned across various sectors including health, education, urban planning, and community perspectives, offering a holistic view of the challenges faced and the strategies that proved successful. A dedicated marketplace and lightning sessions further enhanced knowledge exchange, featuring rapid sharing of learnings and DRR interventions. One of the most pressing issues addressed was the vulnerability of the agricultural sector to climate-induced disasters. Recognized as a vital component for national stability, the discussions stressed the need for resilient agricultural practices capable of withstanding extreme weather events such as floods, droughts, and erratic monsoon patterns. Experts advocated for the adoption of climate-smart agriculture techniques that could fortify crop resilience and minimize the vulnerability of the food supply chain. The importance of integrating DRR into agricultural planning and policy frameworks was underscored, ensuring sustainable practices that can endure the impacts of climate change.

Technology's role was also highlighted, with emphasis on the adoption of advanced tools like satellite imagery and weather modeling to enhance the accuracy of weather forecasts and agricultural planning. The conference called for stronger policy support and increased investment in research, urging for a collaborative effort among government agencies, research institutions, and the private sector to foster innovative techniques. Reflecting on the discussions, the conference concluded with policy feedback sessions that generated vital recommendations for integrating gender equality and inclusion in DRR strategies. These recommendations are set to guide the improvement of institutional capacities, particularly those of NDRRMA, to better prepare for and respond to various disaster events.

The Home Minister promised to dedicate at least a couple of hours monthly to discuss disaster management strategies in coordination with DPNet, reflecting a government commitment to ongoing DRR dialogues. Enhanced understanding of the links between monsoon-related risks, climate change, and livelihoods were recognized as outcomes, alongside strengthened collaboration among stakeholders across different sectors. As the conference closed, the collective resolve to use the gleaned insights to inform not only national policies but also to contribute to the Global Platform for Disaster Risk Reduction 2025 was substantial. For more information about the event, please contact: Dr. Raju Thapa, Chairperson of DPnet, at advrajuthapa@gmail.com or, Mr. Suraj Gautam, General Secretary of DPNet, at ersurajgautam@gmail.com

During the event, the National Technical Coordinator of NHSRP presented a comprehensive paper titled **"Strengthening private housing recovery and reconstruction governance: lessons from floods, landslides, and earthquakes recovery challenges."** The presentation focused on the impacts of the Western Nepal earthquake and the September 2024 floods and landslides, emphasizing the critical lessons learned and actionable insights for improving recovery systems.

He has highlighted the major activities undertaken by the three tiers of government (federal, provincial, and local) in collaboration with development partners to support the earthquake-affected communities. The presentation detailed various initiatives, including emergency response efforts, temporary shelter construction and permanent shelter for floods, landslides and fire affected households undertaken by NDRRMA since 2077.

In addition, the paper shed light on the key policy, financial, structural, and operational challenges encountered during the recovery and reconstruction process. Drawing from the findings of a localization study conducted by the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA), the speaker underscored the importance of integrating localized approaches to enhance disaster resilience and sustainability in recovery efforts. For more information, please contact: Mr. Rijan Gajurel, National Technical Coordinator of NHSRP, at Rijan.gajurel@hrrpnepal.org .

NHSRP/CRS also participated in the Marketplace at the National Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction (NCDRR) held on December 26 and 27, 2024. The event provided a platform to showcase key initiatives, tools, and achievements in disaster risk reduction and recovery. Through interactive displays and discussions, NHSRP/CRS highlighted its ongoing projects, shared success stories, and engaged with participants to promote innovative solutions for building resilient communities. The Marketplace served as a valuable opportunity to connect with stakeholders, exchange ideas, and strengthen partnerships for a safer and more prepared Nepal. For more information about Market place and product , please contact: Mr. Rajesh Sunuwar, Provincial Technical Coordinator of NHSRP, at Rajesh.Sunuwar@hrrpnepal.org.

Earthquake safety day: nationwide efforts for strong structures and robust preparedness

Earthquake Safety Day is set to be commemorated on **24 December 2024**, with the main event scheduled to take place in Kirtipur Municipality on Magh 2 (January 15). The theme for this year's observance is "Lessons from Earthquakes: Strong Structures and Robust Preparedness." During a meeting chaired by Hon. Home Minister Ramesh Lekhak, the main ceremony committee finalized the event's venue and theme. Key dignitaries, including Physical Infrastructure and Transport Minister Devendra Dahal, Lalitpur Metropolitan City Mayor Chiribabu Maharjan, and Home Secretary Gokarnamani Duwadi, participated in the discussion. Other notable attendees included senior officials such as military generals, the Inspector General of Nepal Police, the Chief of Armed Police Force, the Chief Investigation Director, and mayors of municipalities across the Kathmandu Valley, including Kirtipur. Heads and representatives from various civil and governmental organizations were also present.

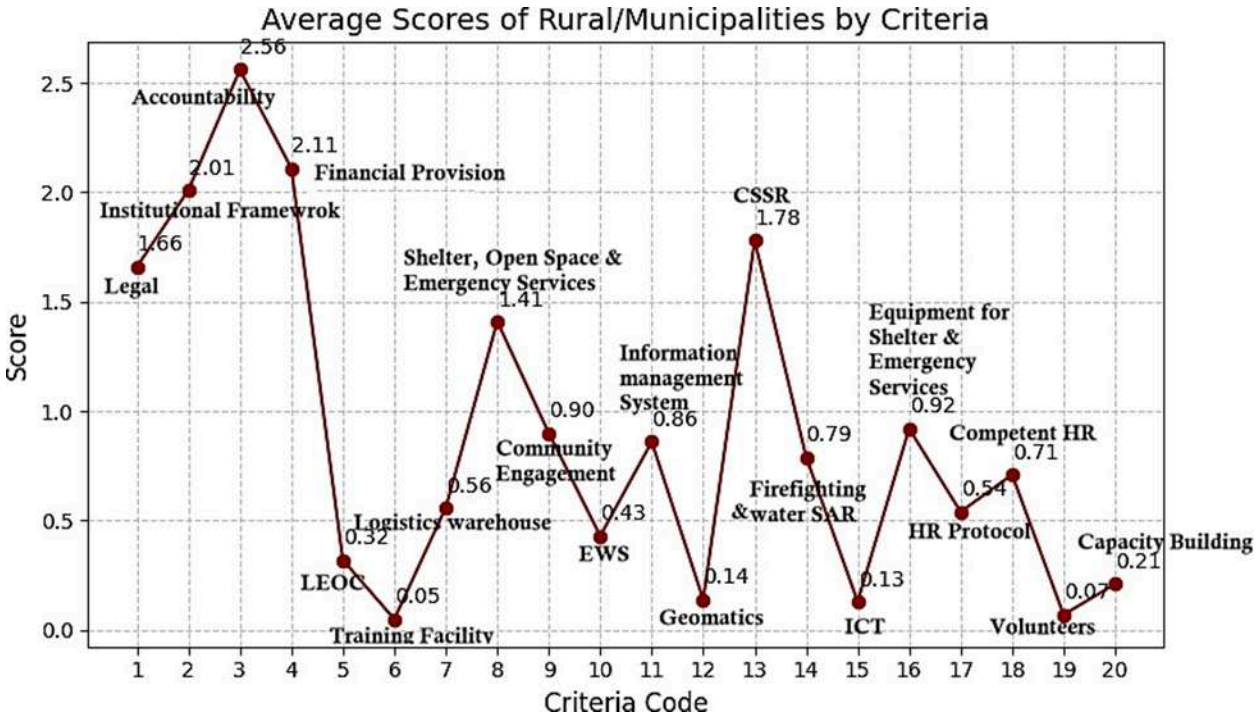
In his remarks, Minister Lekhak emphasized the importance of celebrating Earthquake Safety Day as a nationwide initiative to promote awareness and preparedness for mitigating earthquake risks. Krishna Man Dangol, the Mayor of Kirtipur Municipality, expressed his commitment to successfully hosting the main event, ensuring meaningful participation and impactful activities. The meeting also called on provinces, local governments, and civil society organizations to organize awareness campaigns and preparedness programs across the country. These efforts aim to enhance disaster resilience and educate the public on effective measures to reduce earthquake-related risks. For more information contact: Mr. Rabin Chaulagain Rabin.chaulagain@hrrpnepal.org , National Technical Coordinator, NHSRP.

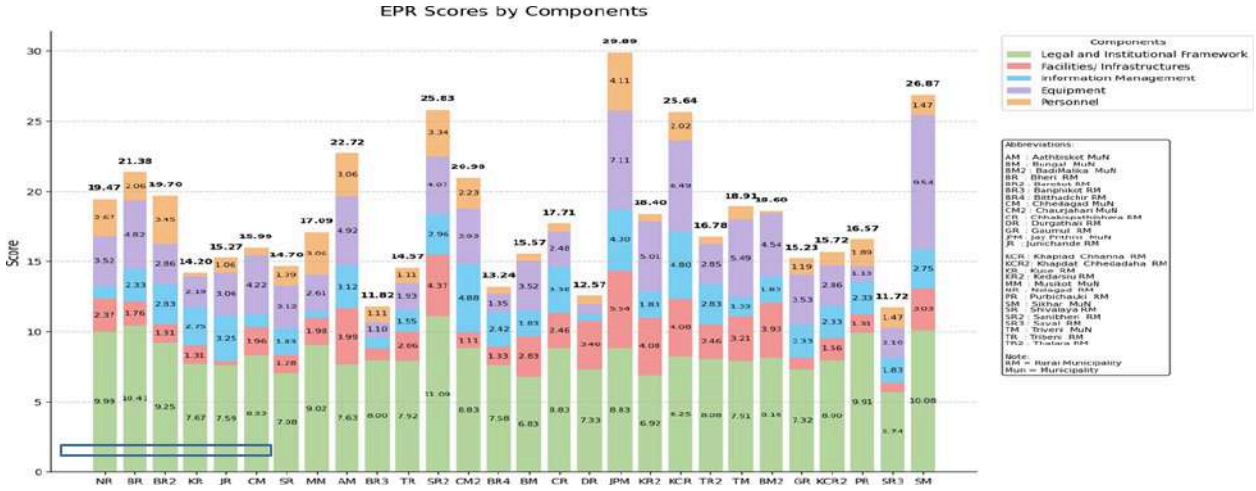
Enhancing local emergency preparedness: findings from western Nepal's EP&R assessment:

On December 16, the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) hosted a discussion on the findings of the Emergency Preparedness and Response (EP&R) Assessment Report. The session included participation from NDRRMA officials, various ministries, government and donor agencies, UN organizations, and NGOs. Given Nepal's high vulnerability to earthquakes, with recent incidents in the western region resulting in 161 deaths, over 62,000 damaged houses, and the displacement of more than 75,000 families across 28 municipalities, the assessment aimed to evaluate the EP&R capacity of local governments in 28 municipalities of 5 districts of Karnali and Sudurpaschim Provinces.

The study, led by NDRRMA in collaboration with the Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration and supported by the International Organization for Migration (IOM), was funded by USAID's Bureau for Humanitarian Assistance. It employed the Ready to Respond (R2R) diagnostic methodology—a data-driven tool designed to assess legal frameworks, information systems, facilities, equipment, and personnel. The assessment spanned 18 criteria, 72 indicators, and 360 attributes. The findings revealed significant gaps in local EP&R capacities and offered recommendations, including financial investments, to strengthen disaster response and resilience. The aggregated score for the twenty-eight municipalities is only 18.16 out of 100. For further information, Please coordinate Ms.Dipina

Sharma, dsharma@iom.int , National Program Officer/ Head Migration, Environment, Climate Change and Risk Reduction Department, IOM.





NDRRMA convened a partner meeting with all international NGOs (INGOs)

On December 19, the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) convened a partner meeting with all international NGOs (INGOs) working in disaster risk reduction and management sectors. The meeting focused on advancing post-earthquake recovery efforts in Western Nepal more effectively. Discussions were held with representatives of INGOs affiliated with the Association of International NGOs in Nepal (AIN).

The meeting was chaired by NDRRMA's Joint Secretary, Dr. Bhisma Kumar Bhusal, and included a review of the work already undertaken by the INGOs, as well as plans for future initiatives. A significant portion of the discussion revolved around sharing progress and identifying areas where further collaboration is required to ensure comprehensive and efficient recovery.

The INGOs committed to providing detailed information about their ongoing and planned activities to contribute to the **Post-Disaster Recovery Plan (PDRP)**. This Plan aims to consolidate efforts and streamline recovery strategies, addressing gaps and leveraging resources for a coordinated approach to disaster recovery and resilience building.

The meeting emphasized the importance of timely and collaborative action to support communities affected by recent earthquakes in Western Nepal, ensuring that recovery is both effective and sustainable. For more information contact: Mr.Rijan Gajurel, Rijan.gajurel@hrrpnepal.org , National Technical Coordinator, NHSRP.

PARTNERS' UPDATES

Cross-country collaboration in Anticipatory Action:

To promote the exchange of cross-country knowledge, experiences, best practices, challenges, and lessons learned in Anticipatory Action (AA) implementation, the AA Clinic organized a learning and sharing workshop on December 20, 2024. AA Clinic is the specialized unit established within NDRRMA and is dedicated to advancing anticipatory action by providing technical support, guidance, and strategic direction to organizations and agencies working on or planning AA initiatives. This event convened government officials and practitioners from Nepal and Bangladesh, providing a platform for collaboration and mutual learning. This initiative aimed to strengthen collective efforts in Anticipatory Action, fostering improved coordination and implementation across both countries. For more information contact: reeba@rodekors.dk , Technical Coordinator - AA Clinic, NDRRMA

Emergency response to September floods in Nepal:

The recent September floods in Nepal severely impacted 21 districts, affecting approximately 135,000 people. In response, **Start Fund Nepal members** including ActionAid Nepal, CRS Nepal, World Vision International Nepal, and Action Against Hunger mobilized support to assist communities in 11 local levels across 9 districts.

Four consortia, led by these organizations, collectively provided assistance to around 40,000 affected individuals. In collaboration with their implementing partners, they delivered cash grants, food support, restoring drinking water schemes and essential relief items, including hygiene kits, shelter materials, and kitchen supplies. Additionally, affected communities received psychosocial counseling and participated in spiritual healing sessions to aid their recovery.

This response was carried out with the support of the UK in Nepal, Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office, National Disaster Risk Reduction & Management Authority, and Start Network, ensuring coordinated and effective humanitarian assistance. For more information contact: Ms.Pramila Subedi, Pramila.Subedi@startnetwork.org , Programme Manager- Start Fund Nepal

Emergency response to Bajura earthquake affected households

Following the 5.2 magnitude earthquake that struck Bajura on December 20, 2024, Save the Children Nepal, in collaboration with Multipurpose Development Society, initiated a response to support the affected communities. In Jagannath Rural Municipality, where 108 houses were completely destroyed, essential life-saving kits were distributed to affected families in wards 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6.

The relief efforts provided Baby Packs for children aged 0–2 and 3–5 years, Basic Shelter Kits to assist in rebuilding temporary shelters, Warm Blankets and Winterization Kits to withstand harsh weather, and Water Jars to ensure access to clean drinking water. In total, 108 families whose homes were fully destroyed received assistance during this emergency response. For more information contact: Mr.Rabin Dahal, rabin.dahal@savethechildren.org.

Upskilling trainee masons at Jajarkot and West Rukum was conducted on Dec 24th - 30th Dec 2024 through on-the-job training approach using Lime Stabilized Soil Technology under Jajarkot Earthquake Recovery Project (JERP) supported by Homes and Communities H&C initiative, led by Caritas Nepal with funding from Catholic Relief Services Nepal. This activity aimed to support earthquake-affected households in Bheri municipality and Aathbiskot rural municipality to construct shelters that are safe, dignified and weatherproof and are compliant with GoN guidelines.

A key part of the project was showcasing practical solutions Lime Stabilized Soil (LSS) technology through 7-days skill mason training covering skills like material investigation; site and personnel safety; material selection; stabilization of soil using quick lime; mixing methods and finishing details. This training aimed to empower local workers with the knowledge needed to build safer earthquake resilient structures using natural local building materials available. Jajarkot and West Rukum experience severe winters, necessitating improved thermal comfort in housing. Cement-based technologies and applications are now dominating housing construction, but these materials do not adequately address the thermal insulation needs effectively. Lime stabilized soil technology offers an environmentally friendly, cost-effective alternative that enhances thermal insulation. This project was initiated to upskill local masons in these districts, equipping them with expertise in utilizing vernacular materials like quick lime, soil, rice husk ash, straw, and sand for wall plastering and flooring. For more information contact: Mr.Rupesh Shrestha, Rupesh.shrestha@hrrpnepal.org, Technical Coordinator

EU Ambassador visits post-earthquake rehabilitation and development efforts in Karnali

The EU Ambassador to Nepal, H.E. Veronique Lorenzo, along with an EU delegation team, visited Jajarkot and Rukum West to assess post-earthquake rehabilitation efforts led by community and local governments, with support from the European Union (EU). The 6.4 magnitude earthquake had severely impacted these districts, affecting numerous households.

During the visit, the delegation engaged with at-risk communities, local government, and provincial representatives, strengthening collaboration in disaster response and preparedness. As part of the EU-supported ACCESS project, the Ambassador met with the Karnali Province-Girls and Inclusive Education Network (GIEN) Committee at the Ministry of Social Development, Karnali Province, Surkhet. The meeting, chaired by Hon. Social Development Minister Ghanshyam Bhandari and Secretary Dirgha Bahadur Pokhrel, focused on promoting equitable, accessible, and quality education in the province.

With support from EU Civil Protection & Humanitarian Aid, Save the Children has provided life-saving kits, winterization tents, and conducted community engagement and awareness sessions to assist earthquake-affected populations. Similarly, through the EU-funded PRATIBADDHA III project, People in Need is working to enhance disaster mitigation, preparedness, and early action across Bagmati, Karnali, Lumbini, and Sudurpaschim provinces. The project builds on lessons from earlier phases to empower at-risk communities and strengthen local and provincial government leadership in disaster resilience.

This visit reinforced the EU's ongoing commitment to disaster resilience, inclusive education, and sustainable development in Nepal through collaborative and impactful initiatives.

Post-GLOF assessment and disaster dialogue on Thame glacial lake outburst floods (GLOF)

A disaster dialogue was conducted at the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) to review key findings from various post-GLOF assessments of the Thame Glacial Lake Outburst Flood (GLOF) in Solukhumbu. The study teams highlighted that significant risks remain and emphasized the need for continuous monitoring, early warning system management, and identification of safe relocation sites for

damaged houses and schools to prevent further losses in the upcoming monsoon season.

This assessment was carried out in coordination with the Government of Nepal, Ministry of Home Affairs, and facilitated by NDRRMA. The post-GLOF study was conducted by Kathmandu University, BGC Engineering (USA), and ICIMOD, focusing on the impact and necessary mitigation measures for Thame.

The GLOF event on August 16, 2023 (Shrawan 32, 2080) in Thame, Khumbu Pasang Lhamu Rural Municipality, caused severe damage, leading to the destruction of 38 houses, two hotels, and a health post in Thame Bazaar. The discussions aimed at developing effective risk reduction strategies and enhancing preparedness measures to mitigate future disasters in the region.

High-level discussion on localizing Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) in disaster risk reduction and management

On December 11, 2024, a high-level discussion was held to strengthen collaboration and effectiveness in localizing the strategic action plan for Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI) in Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (DRRM). The discussion focused on fostering mutual cooperation among key stakeholders to ensure an inclusive and equitable approach to disaster risk management.

The event brought together representatives from government agencies, UN agencies, CRS and disaster response partner organizations, who expressed their commitment to integrating GEDSI principles within their respective sectors. The discussion highlighted the importance of coordinated actions and shared responsibility in building resilient and inclusive disaster management systems, ensuring that disaster preparedness and response efforts address the needs of women, persons with disabilities, and marginalized communities.

Review of resilient, Inclusive and sustainable building technologies in Nepal

Joint collaboration between Build up Nepal, Scott Wilson Nepal and National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform (NHSRP) conducted the study of sustainable housing practice across eight municipalities in Nepal. This study aims to generate technical evidence on the resilience, sustainability, inclusivity, social development contribution, and scalability of various building technologies and to enhance the capacity of local entrepreneurs and construction professionals in eight municipalities to adopt these technologies and integrate them into their business models. The results will support the Government of Nepal and local stakeholders in identifying and promoting cost-efficient, resilient, and inclusive as well as scalable reconstruction solutions for tackling

the vulnerability of public buildings and private houses to multiple hazards. The specific objectives of this assignment are:

Technical Assessment: To evaluate different construction technologies based on their resilience, sustainability, inclusivity, and contribution to local development. This will be achieved through an ecosystem and life cycle cost analysis Business Development and Continuity Planning: To create replicable business plans that will help local entrepreneurs and construction professionals in the selected municipalities adopt and promote resilient and sustainable building practices.

Capacity Building: To train local masons and entrepreneurs on the design, construction, and business planning for resilient, inclusive, and sustainable technologies, thus ensuring their broader adoption in vulnerable communities.

Consultation Workshop on Strengthening Loss and Damage Data Sharing and Integration Mechanisms for Nepal's Disaster Management Portal

On December 22, 2024, a consultation workshop on "Strengthening Loss and Damage Data Sharing and Integration Mechanisms for Nepal's Disaster Management Portal" was held in Kathmandu, organized by Youth Innovation Lab in collaboration with NDRRMA as part of the study Piloting L&D Assessment Frameworks for Climate-Induced Hazards,a study of YI-Lab in partnership with DCA Nepal, SOSEC Nepal and KMJS Nepal. The event brought together representatives from various government levels and researchers to address challenges in managing economic and non-economic L&D data. Discussions covered standardizing reporting indicators, findings from assessments in climate-affected areas like Dullu and Gulariya, and a case study from Kanchanpur, which underscored significant economic and non-economic losses. Identified gaps in Nepal's Disaster Information Management System (DIMS) and proposed solutions included mobile apps for real-time geo-tagged data collection, standardized templates, and enhanced data validation. Key challenges such as limited resources, fragmented data management, and political interference were highlighted, with recommendations focusing on aligning Nepal's hazard classification with global standards, improving localized early warning systems, and strengthening data collection tools. The workshop concluded with discussions on strategies to enhance L&D tracking and reporting across sectors.For more information contact: Ms. Deepshikha Nepal, Climate Change Research Associate, deepshikha@youthinnovationlab.org

NHSRP's PROVINCIAL ENGAGEMENTS

UPDATES FROM SUDURPASCHIM

Orientation to LEOC on Bipad Portal, DRR Portal and digitizing the VCA data

On **27th December 2024**, members of the Local Emergency Operation Centres (LEOCs) in Bardagoriya Rural Municipality, Kailali, were oriented on the use and application of the Bipad portal and Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) portals. The session also included training on digitizing Vulnerability and Capacity Assessment (VCA) data. Organized in coordination with the respective municipality and with support from partner organization RDN, the orientation targeted government officials involved in DRR activities, including ward secretaries, to enhance their skills in disaster management and data digitization. A total of 24 participants attended the session, which was facilitated by the DRR and Climate Justice Coordinator from Habitat Nepal.: sabin.shrestha@hrrpnepal.org

UPDATES FROM KARNALI

On December 11, 2024, **a one-day workshop on earthquake response, early recovery, and reconstruction** was jointly organized by the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law (MoIAL) and the JRAP project, in collaboration with NHSRP. The workshop was chaired by the MoIAL Secretary, with the Chief Secretary of Karnali Province as the Chief Guest.The program had approximately 110 participants, including representatives from NDRRMA, all provincial ministries, the Provincial Planning Commission, the Insurance Authority, all security forces, Surkhet DAO, and elected representatives, Chief Administrative Officers (CAOs), and disaster focal persons from Jajarkot, Salyan, and Rukum West municipalities. Additionally, representatives from the Nepal Red Cross Society, the Federation of Nepalese Journalists, the Federation of Nepalese Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FNCCI), UN

agencies, AIN members, the NGO Federation, and development sector partners were in attendance.

The event commenced with the MoIAL Secretary reading the program banner, followed by a welcome speech by the Under Secretary of MoIAL Karnali. During the workshop, NDRRMA, various ministries, municipalities, the Insurance Authority, and development sector organizations (NHSRP, PIN, Caritas, and IOM) presented reflections on emergency response and early recovery efforts. Furthermore, NDRRMA and MoIAL Karnali presented the Government of Nepal's vision and plans for reconstruction and rehabilitation.
The workshop emphasized the urgent need to complete key activities for the reconstruction process, including detailed damage assessment and the preparation of reconstruction guidelines. These activities were identified as critical to advancing reconstruction efforts. The event marked a significant milestone for Jajarkot's reconstruction and recovery, with all participants expressing satisfaction with the program's outcomes.

On December 26, 2024, in coordination with Barekot Rural Municipality under the JRAP project **NHSRP successfully conducted the LDCRF endorsement workshop in Barekot.** The event was chaired by the Chairman of Barekot Rural Municipality, Mr. Bir Bahadur Giri, with Dr. Gangaram Tuladhar serving as the Chief Guest. Participants included representatives from various municipal departments, executive members of the municipality, ward presidents, security forces (including the Army, Police, and Armed Police Force), representatives from UN agencies, the development sector, and various political parties.

The program was facilitated by the Disaster Focal Person, Mr. Khaegndra Bahadur Bohera, with a welcome address delivered by the CAO, Mr. Lokraj Khatri. Dr. Gangaram Tuladhar delivered encouraging remarks, emphasizing the critical role of the LDCRF in strengthening disaster risk reduction and management (DRRM) efforts. During the event, Mr. Banshi Acharya presented the finalized LDCRF, incorporating real-time corrections where necessary. Additionally, the NHSRP National Coordinator provided an overview of the way forward for recovery and reconstruction action plans and shared details of NHSRP's upcoming activities and support initiatives.

The workshop concluded with final remarks from Chairman Mr. Bir Bahadur Giri, who highlighted the importance of the LDCRF and expressed heartfelt gratitude to NHSRP for their contributions. He also announced plans to present the LDCRF for formal approval during the Bidhan Sabha session, scheduled for January 6, 2025.

For more information please contact: Mr.Ujjwal Adhikari, Provincial Technical Coordinator of NHSRP, Ujjwal Adhikari ujjwal.adhikari@hrrpnepal.org

District-level interaction on LDCRF framework and post-earthquake response

On December 20 and 22, 2024, district-level interaction meetings on the Local Disaster Climate and Resilience Framework (LDCRF) were held in West Rukum and Jajarkot, chaired by the Chief District

Officers (CDOs). The meetings brought together District disaster management committee (DDMC) members and local stakeholders to discuss strategies for disaster preparedness and risk governance. DRRM expert Mr. Bamshi Kumar Acharya elaborated on the LDCRF and the District Preparedness and Response Plan (DPRP), emphasizing their interconnected roles in managing disaster and climate risks. Discussions centered on multi-hazard early warning systems, financial mechanisms, capacity-building initiatives, and integrating local disaster risk governance. The meetings underscored the necessity of collaborative efforts between local governments and stakeholders to enhance disaster resilience and adaptive strategies.

In the aftermath of recent earthquakes, Mr. Rijan Gajurel, National Technical Coordinator of NHSRP, presented the Joint Recovery Action Plan (JRAP) efforts in post-earthquake shelter recovery. He highlighted the vulnerabilities of Karnali Province and Jajarkot, linking them to local building typologies and aftershock risks. Key insights from NDRRMA's geo-hazard assessments were shared, classifying the affected areas into different vulnerability categories. Discussions covered relief distribution efforts, emergency shelter support, socio-technical assistance through NHSRP under IOM's guidance, and funding contributions for disaster response. Additionally, the meeting emphasized the role of municipalities in reconstruction, the progress of recovery initiatives, and strategies for long-term resilience and sustainable rebuilding efforts.

UPDATES FROM LUMBINI

Strengthening Loss and Damage Data IntegrationAs a Representative from Lumbini Province Ministry of Internal Affairs & Law NHSRP Technical Coordinator had an opportunity to participate on ***Strengthening Loss and Damage Data Integration*** Program at Hotel Himalaya Lalitpur on 23rd December Organized by Youth Innovation Lab, in collaboration with NDRRMA, hosted a workshop on enhancing Loss and Damage (L&D) data sharing and integration for Nepal's Disaster Information Management System. The event brought together representatives from local, provincial, and federal ministries, line agencies, and researchers specializing in Loss and Damage data collection, sharing, and integration.Er. Arjun Kumar Bam, Joint Secretary at NDRRMA, emphasized the need for standardized templates and stronger institutional coordination to strengthen disaster management systems. And the key discussions focused on challenges in managing economic and non-economic L&D data and indicators for standardizing reporting across sectors.

This workshop marks a significant step toward transforming the Disaster Information Management System (DIMS) into a robust decision-support tool.YIL expresses their gratitude to NDRRMA, and their study partners DCA Nepal, Sosec Nepal, KMJS, CRR Labs, and EERC. With: National Disaster Risk Reduction & Management Authority DCA Nepal SOSEC Nepal Environment and Engineering Research Center -EERC Nepal Youth Innovation Lab.

On December 3, 2024, a focal group discussion was held in Devikot, Ward No. 9 of Rapti Rural Municipality, focusing on the challenges associated with mud stone masonry houses, particularly the formation of cracks below lintel levels. The meeting noted that while local labor possesses substantial practical experience, they often lack formal certification. In the ward, there are a total of 365 houses, predominantly wooden structures, with only 4 constructed from reinforced cement concrete (RCC). Notably, women predominantly serve as heads of households in this community. The primary income sources for residents are agriculture and foreign employment, primarily in India. Participants emphasized the pressing need for training programs to enhance the skills of local labor and provide guidance on construction practices. The only locally available construction materials are mud and stone, and the average reported cost of constructing a wooden house, including finishing, is NPR 170,000, with 8 to 10 wooden houses being built annually in the area.

On December 3, 2024, a focal group discussion was conducted in Maurighat, Ward No. 4 of Rapti Rural Municipality, focusing on local resources and construction practices. The available construction materials primarily consist of stone, aggregate, sand, and wood. However, stone excavation in the area presents significant challenges, as most stones are sourced from rivers, which, while suitable for construction, can be costly. The stones are frequently transported from crushers, with aggregate prices ranging from Rs. 28 to Rs. 30 per cubic foot, excluding transportation costs.

In terms of brick supply, bricks are sourced from chimneys, and the ward sees the construction of approximately 100 houses per year. Notably, the local migrant population is less active in construction compared to residents. Women play a crucial role in the construction sector, primarily working as laborers, which reflects an increasing trend of female participation in this industry. Additionally, bamboo, which is locally available, is recognized by both local contractors and residents as a practical and favorable material for construction.

Migrant workers from Salyan, Rolpa, and Puthan significantly contribute to the community, with a marked preference for constructing Reinforced Cement Concrete (RCC) buildings. This preference is due to RCC structures' earthquake-resistant features and their reduced susceptibility to cracks, making them safer alternatives compared to traditional stone and mud construction methods.

On December 3, 2024, a focal group discussion was held in Bagrapur, Ward No. 6 of Rapti Rural Municipality, where it was observed that the majority of residents have transitioned to constructing houses using Reinforced Cement Concrete (RCC) frame structures, effectively replacing traditional thatch houses. While RCC constructions are recognized for their time efficiency and are primarily built by local laborers, there is a notable lack of adherence to building codes and regulations, with minimal consultation from engineers during the construction process.

Residents expressed that older house, despite facing issues such as deterioration and safety risks from pests, are often perceived as more comfortable than the newer RCC structures. Furthermore, fire hazards remain a significant concern for traditional homes. The primary sources of income in the region include agriculture and foreign employment, with some homestays also utilizing RCC frame structures to accommodate guests.

On December 3, 2024, a focal group discussion was held in Lalmatiya, Ward No. 3 of Rapti Rural Municipality, which addressed various aspects of construction practices and local resources. The community primarily sources materials such as wood and sand from the river, while bricks are transported directly from quarry sites. There has been a notable shift from traditional constructions to Reinforced Cement Concrete (RCC) structures, which require less frequent maintenance due to their durability. However, adherence to building regulations is inconsistent; while engineers are consulted when construction laws are followed, many projects rely on local contractors who often proceed without proper plans or oversight.

Women laborers play a significant role in the construction process but experience a wage gap compared to their male counterparts. Additionally, safety measures on construction sites are often inadequate, and the quality of sand and aggregates used is frequently overlooked by households. Cement and sand are primarily sourced from Dang and surrounding areas, with excavation conducted through a bidding process in accordance with municipal regulations.

The main sources of income in the area continue to be agriculture and foreign employment, with a noticeable influx of migrants from Salyan, Rolpa, and Puthan. Bamboo is also locally available and is regarded by both contractors and residents as a practical and favorable construction material. During the discussion, Mr. Anil Rijal from the SW team contributed valuable insights regarding accidental insurance policies and labor terms and conditions.

In Ward No. 4, the primary materials utilized for building construction include brick masonry and reinforced cement concrete (RCC). The cost of each brick is Rs. 12, with an additional transportation fee of Rs. 1 from the chimney to the construction site. However, it was observed that building norms are not consistently adhered to. Residents are primarily responsible for constructing their houses, with labor charges set at Rs. 950 for male workers and Rs. 500 for female workers.

Prabhat Hardware offers a range of construction materials, with Bajaj Steel being the most commonly sold reinforcement steel at a price of Rs. 81 per kg. The cost of PPC cement is Rs. 560 per bag, while OPC cement is priced at Rs. 660 per bag, with Sagarmatha Cement serving as the primary local supplier. Both skilled and unskilled labor are available for construction projects; however, it is important to note that these workers are not formally certified, relying instead on their practical experience. Furthermore, the awareness of building norms among the labor force remains unclear.

Chairman Deepak Kumar Chaudhary of Ward No. 6 has observed that local residents do not consistently adhere to building rules and regulations. In the area, the majority of houses are constructed using Reinforced Cement Concrete (RCC) structures. Furthermore, both Ward No. 5 and 6 are characterized by marshy land and flood-prone zones, which present significant challenges for construction practices.The primary sources of income for local residents are agriculture and foreign employment. Chairman Chaudhary highlighted the necessity for training programs aimed at developing skilled labor within the community. Additionally, locally sourced materials, such as sand and stones, are excavated from the river and utilized in construction, underscoring the community's reliance on available natural resources.

Engineer Ashok Belbase of Rapti Gaunpalika reported that load-bearing houses are rarely constructed in the area, with the majority of homes being built using Reinforced Cement Concrete (RCC) structures. It was noted that local residents frequently do not adhere to established building norms, which raises concerns about the safety and quality of construction. Additionally, locals expressed that obtaining a building naksa pass (design approval) can be prohibitively expensive.As a result, many residents are facing challenges with bank loans, leading them to opt for property registration (abhilekhekaran) instead. The primary sources of income for the local community remain agriculture and foreign employment. Stone and sand excavation rights are allocated to contractors through a competitive bidding process organized by the Gaunpalika. Although high-quality construction materials such as stone and sand can be sourced from the river, these resources are severely affected by flooding, which poses further challenges for construction practices in the area.

UPDATES FROM GANDAKI

Orientation on RMIS system to DRR focal person and engineer of Pokhara metropolitan. Regular technical support on Kobo collect, RMIS. inspection and fund release for the monsoon induced reconstruction to the DAO Kaski, Badigaon, Modi RM, Bandipur, Rising, Mygadi.

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UPDATES FROM BAGMATI

Provincial disaster management executive meeting, Bagamati Province

The Provincial Disaster Management Executive Meeting was held on December 24, 2024, under the chairmanship of the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law, Bagmati Province, with the Chief Minister of Bagmati Province as the chief guest. All provincial secretaries and ministry representatives were present at the meeting. The meeting decided to allocate a budget for the maintenance of roads damaged by the heavy rains that occurred between September 26 and 28, 2024.

Early recovery cluster meeting, Bagamati Province

On December 4, 2024, the Early Recovery Cluster Meeting was held in the meeting hall of the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law, Bagmati Province, in the presence of the Secretary. Disaster focal persons from all provincial ministries attended the meeting. The meeting decided to update the Provincial Disaster Preparedness and Response Plan in consultation with relevant stakeholders. The attendance sheet and decisions are attached here. Click here for more details.

Inter province level workshop on peace, security and disaster management, Kathmandu Nepal

On December 12, an inter-province level workshop on Peace, Security, and Disaster Management was organized in Kathmandu, Nepal, coordinated by the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law, Bagmati Province. The workshop was held with the Honorable Minister of Home Affairs, Mr. Ramesh Lekhak, as the chief guest. The Chief Minister of Gandaki Province was also present, along with ministers from other provinces. During the workshop, disaster focal ministries from all seven provinces presented their existing disaster-related programs and activities, as well as their expectations for support from the federal government.

Orientation for Volunteers, Technical Personnel, IT Officers, and DRR focal person on Temporary Shelter Tranche distribution Guidelines and BIPAD Portal Data Entry Processes at Roshi Rural Municipality, Panauti Municipality and Bethanchowk Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchowk on 12 Dec 2024.

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UPDATES FROM KOSHI

Orientation on temporary shelter tranche distribution guidelines and Bipad portal data entry processes

An orientation session was conducted for the Technical Personnel, IT Officer, and DRR Focal Person of

Phalgunanda Rural Municipality on the Temporary Shelter Tranche Distribution Guidelines and the BIPAD Portal Data Entry Processes.Following the orientation, the technical team initiated data entry into the BIPAD portal. To date, entries for 14 households have been completed, and 10 households have signed the MoU under the Temporary Shelter program.

In September and October 2024, heavy rainfall caused widespread destruction across the Bagmati and Koshi provinces, leading the government to designate 71 local units, including Sandakpur Rural Municipality in Ilam district, as Crisis Palikas. In response, 20 households in Sandakpur RM received the first installment of support for temporary shelters from the Palika and have commenced their construction.

Fig. Temporary Shelter and Toilet of Thakur Singh, Sandakpur RM, Ilam.

September Flood and Landslide Response update

September 2024 Flood and Landslide Response

SN	District	Palika	Damage Level HHs		Temporay Shelter			
			Fully damaged HHs	Partially Damaged HHs	Bipad Portal Entry	MOU Signing	1st Tranche	2nd Tranche
1	Ilam	Sandakpur RM	21	50	21	21	20	
2	Panchthar	Phidim Mun	125	193	90	52		
3		Phalgunanda RM	23	45	14	10		
4		Falelung RM	70	150	21	10		
5	Okhaldhunga	Sunkoshi Mun	13	50	13	11	10	
6		Manebhanjang RM	20	20	0	0		
7		Champadevi RM	150	200	88	10		
8	Solukhumbu	Solu Dhudhkoshi RM	5	9	1			
9		Mapya Dudhkoshi RM	4					
10		Khumbu Panang RM	0	60				
11	Udayapur	Belaka Mun	150	200				
12	Khotang	Dektal Rupakot Mun	4	0	1			
13		Jantedhunga RM	0	2				
14		Halesi Mun	5	0	4	1		
		Total	**590**	**979**	**253**	**115**	**30**	**0**

Joint monitoring and damage assessment of Yogmaya Siddhiprapti Tapasya Gufa and Meditation Center

On 2nd & 3rd December, a joint monitoring team comprising technical personnel from the NHSRP and Salpasilchok Rural Municipality conducted a damage assessment of the Yogmaya Siddhiprapti Tapasya Gufa and Meditation Center in Salpasilchok Rural Municipality, Bhojpur. The damage was caused by recent heavy rainfall and landslides in the region.Following the assessment, a proposal for the renovation of the Yogmaya Siddhiprapti Tapasya Gufa retaining wall, the protection wall of the Yogmaya Main Temple, and the protective structure for the Savyatra Marga was finalized. The proposal has been submitted to the Rural Municipality, the Yogmaya Siddhiprapti Tapasya Gufa and Meditation Center Management Office, and NDRRMA.

Early recovery cluster meeting, Koshi Province: Focus on 2024 September floods and Landslides

The Early Recovery Cluster Meeting in Koshi Province was organized by the Ministry of Internal Affairs and Law (MOIAL), Koshi Province, in coordination with UNDP and NHSRP. The meeting was chaired by Acting Provincial Secretary Mr. Kamal Bahadur Thapa of MOIAL, Koshi.

During the meeting, Mr. Baburam Sharma Luitel, Under-Secretary of the Peace, Security, and Disaster Management Division, provided an overview of the provincial situation and response efforts following the recent floods and landslides.

Development partners, including UNDP, WFP, WHO, NHSRP, Caritas Nepal, Habitat for Humanity, LWF, RRN, and LUMANTI Support Group for Shelter, shared updates on their progress and the activities carried out to support early recovery efforts in response to the disaster.

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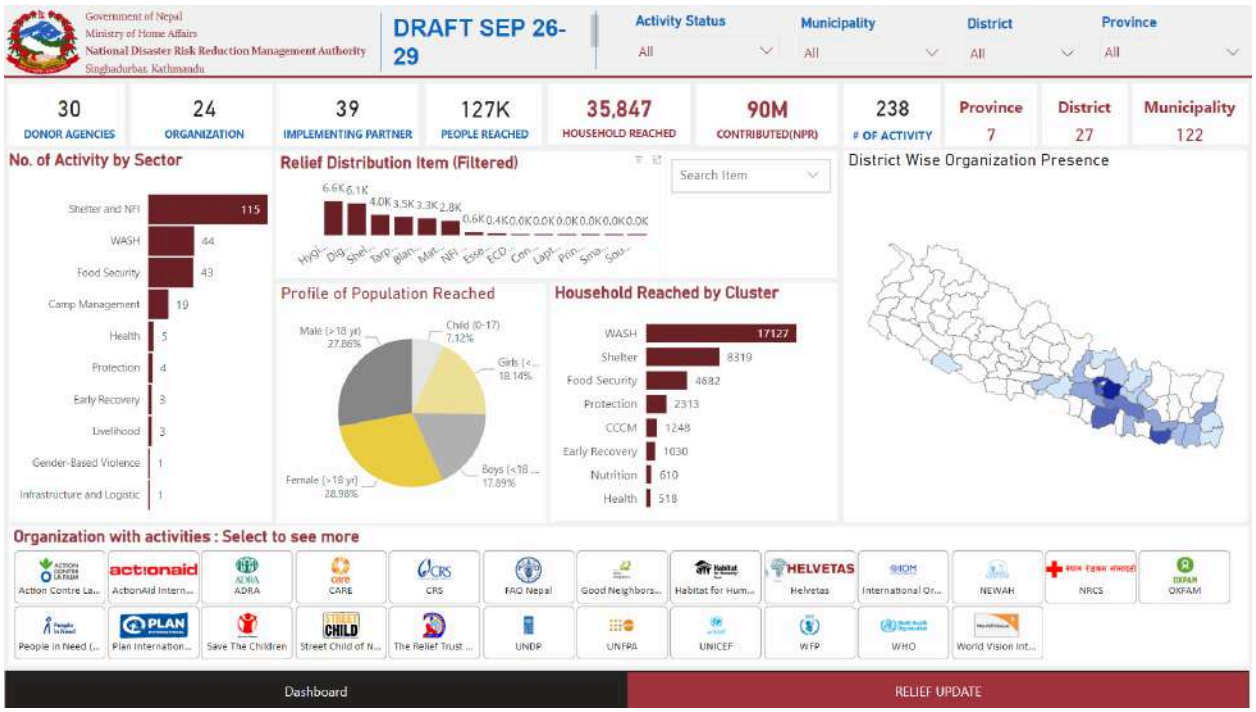
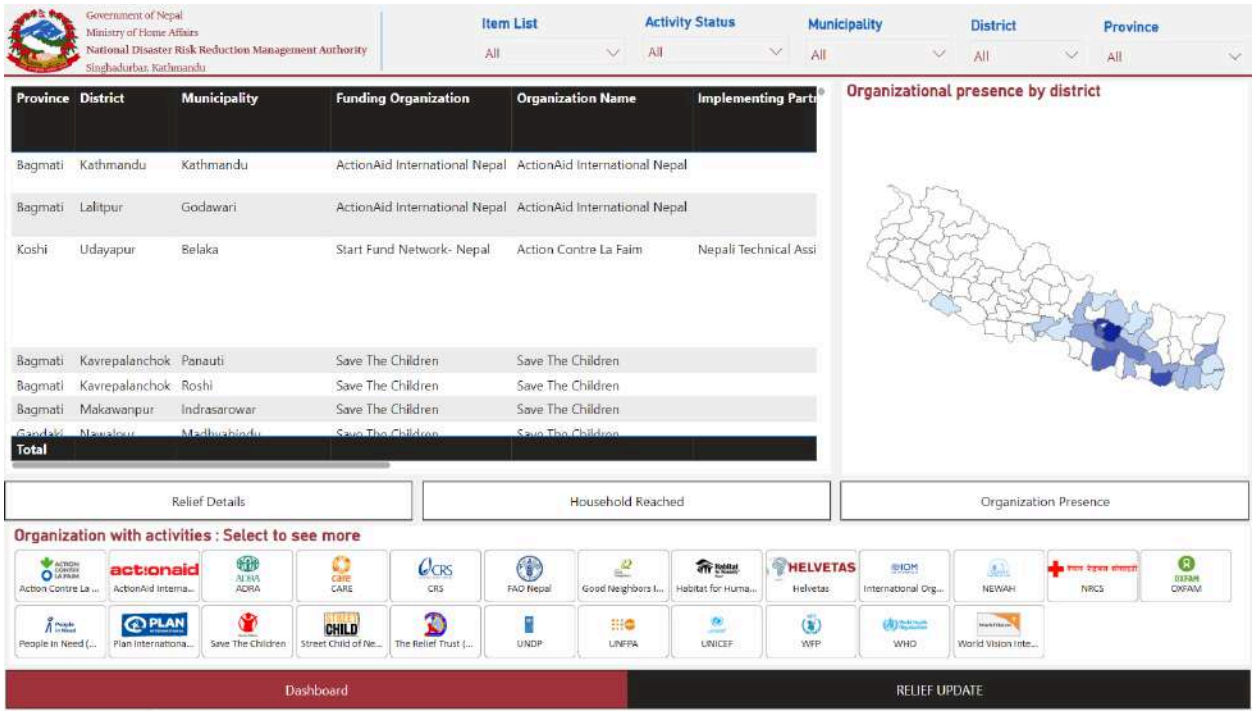
NDRRMA PRODUCTS

5W Dashboard of floods and landslides



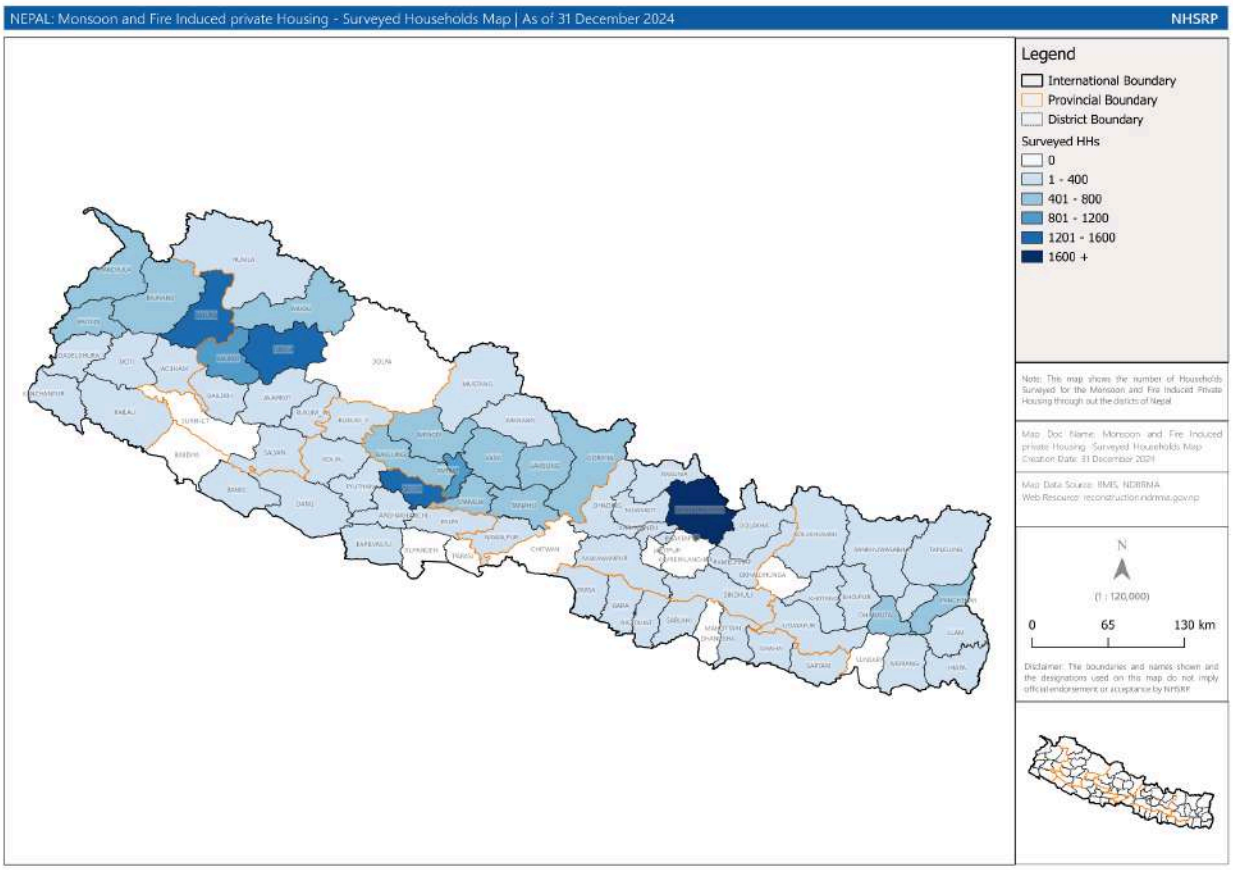
National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform, Nepal



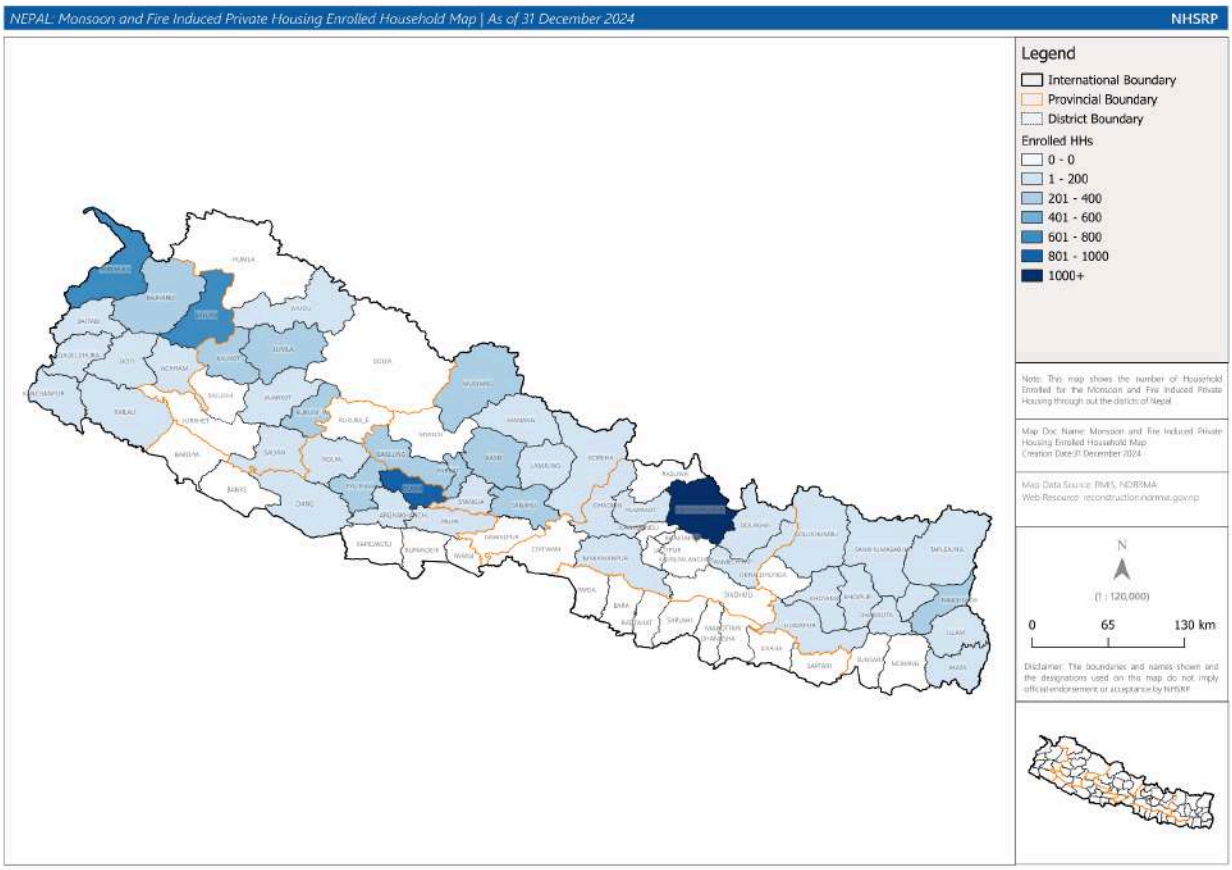
Public Service Announcement (PSA) to safeguard against Air Pollution and Cold Waves

NHSRP PRODUCTS -MAPS

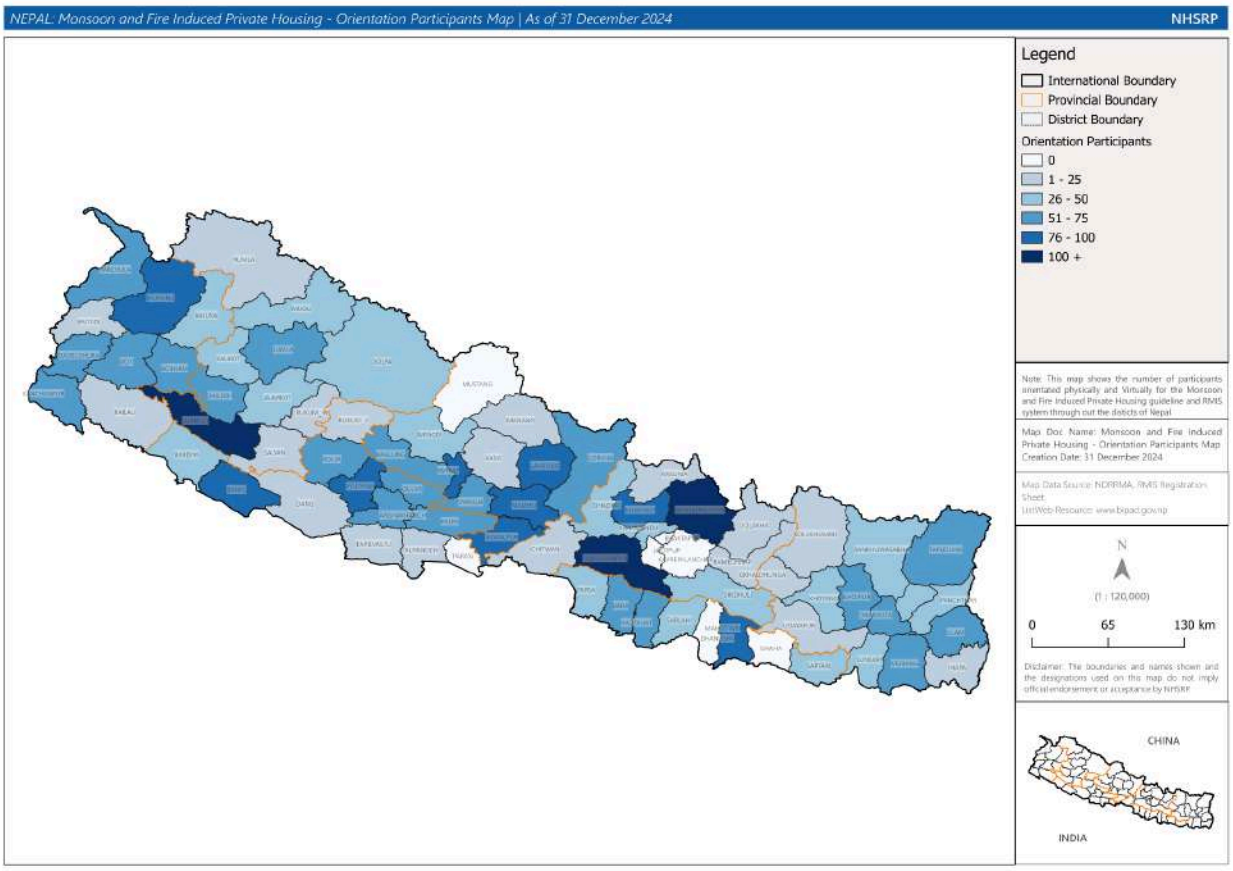
Surveyed Households of Monsoon and Fire Induced Private Housing Reconstruction (31 December 2024):



Enrolled households progress for Monsoon and Fire Induced Private Housing Reconstruction (31 December 2024)

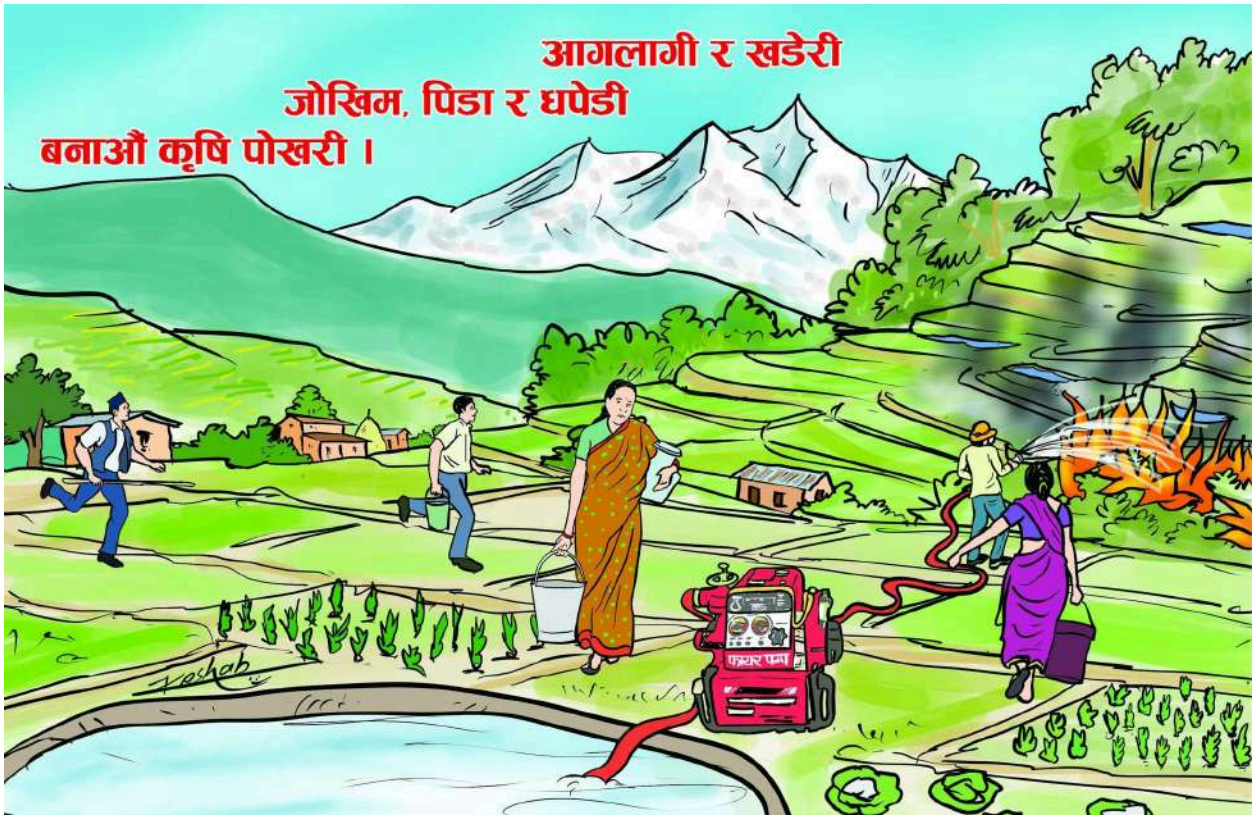


Participants of Physical and Virtual Orientation on Monsoon/Fire-Induced Private Housing Reconstruction Guideline, along with RMIS and Bipad Apps (31 December 2024):



KNOW MORE PLATFORM

In areas without a natural water source, let's construct artificial ponds to address challenges such as fires and droughts.



****APPLICATION CALL FOR THE SECOND COHORT OF WASTE SMART FELLOWSHIP GRANT FOR GREENSHIFT NEPAL PROJECT****

Application Guideline in Nepali: https://bitly.cx/WXwanD

Learn more about the Waste Smart Fellowship Grant at https://bit.ly/3ObaDOR

To apply for the Waste Smart Fellowship Grant, submit your online form at https://bitly.cx/v6rXUT by 15 December 2024.

For any queries, please reach out to the Fellowship Secretariat at fellowship@youthinnovationlab.org

****Free Courses on Shelter and Settlements****

This free course by InterAction and USAID/OFDA provides an overview of the humanitarian community's shelter and settlements activities and examines trends based on past experiences. More here www.disasterready.org

IMPORTANT LINKS

Follow, Like and Subscribe: https://www.facebook.com/NDRRMA, bipad.gov.np/np,
Access: GRID Flyer Nepali version
Access: GRID Flyer English version
Access: UNDRR's upcoming calendar of training events
Access: Compiled Report_Incidents of Monsoon-induced disaster_2079
Access: Monsoon Preparedness and Response Plan 2079_Government of Nepal
Access: Flood Forecasting and Early Warning Report 2078_Government of Nepal
Access: Monsoon Preparedness and Response Plan 2080_Government of Nepal
Access: Monsoon Preparedness and Response Plan 2081 Government of Nepal
Access: DRRM Localization Trainings, Processes, Results, Lesson Learned and Way Forward

Know: Flood Alert in your area, https://www.facebook.com/FlowForecasting
http://drrportal.gov.np/ , http://www.neoc.gov.np/en/ , http://www.mfd.gov.np/
Know: DRR Platform Nepal: https://www.facebook.com/groups/108006329650
http://disasterjournalism.com/, https://www.undrr.org/

AQs | Briefing Pack | Meeting & Events | 5W | Housing Progress | Housing Typologies

National Housing and Settlements Resilience Platform

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UKaid, USAID FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE, CRS, GLOBAL SHELTER CLUSTER Coordinating Humanitarian Shelter and Settlements, IFRC, UNHCR The UN Refugee Agency, NSET, IOM UN MIGRATION, Funded by European Union Humanitarian Aid, People in Need, Habitat for Humanity Nepal, FEDO